APPENDIX 5

Ruby Changes

For most of this book, we assume you are using the most current Ruby version, which is version 3.2 as this is written. With a couple of exceptions, we don't specify when particular features were added to Ruby, as we find that makes the main text more confusing.

This appendix covers changes to Ruby that involve features that are mentioned in this book. There are many more changes in each version, many having to do with core library and gem methods, that are not covered here. Ruby's documentation[1] contains a listing of what was added to each version since 1.8.7. The Ruby Evolution site,[2] maintained by Victor Shepelev, contains more detail about the changes. This appendix is only here to tell you when major changes first appeared, starting with version 2.0. (Older versions are covered by previous versions of this book and were on a different numbering scheme.)

Version 2.0

- `Module#prepend` is introduced.
- Default source encoding changed to UTF-8.
- Refinements are added.
- Keyword arguments are added, but a default value is always required, and the internal implementation still overlaps with positional arguments.
- `%i` is added as a delimiter for a list of symbols.
- Lazy enumerators are added.
- `to_h` and `Kernel#Hash` are added as the convention to convert to Hash objects.
- `TracePoint` is added.
- Numeric values are frozen.

Version 2.1

- Keyword arguments without a default are now allowed.
- `def` now returns the symbol name of the method.
- Literal syntax for rational and complex numbers is added.
- Array and Enumerable get a default `to_h`.

1. https://docs.ruby-lang.org/en
2. https://rubyreferences.github.io/rubychanges/evolution.html